Graham - **00:00**

Sa, It's.

Eric Zelman - **04:17**

What up man?

Graham - **04:18**

Hey, what's up? How you doing?

Eric Zelman - **04:19**

How are you?

Graham - **04:21**

Doing well, how about you?

Eric Zelman - **04:23**

I'm good. Good morning.

Graham - **04:26**

Good evening.

Eric Zelman - **04:33**

Yeah, I am. It's good to see your mug man. So, so. All right, here's the plan. So you know, I got laid off in June, the end of June. And I don't know, I've applied to about 130 jobs and I get like a 4% return rate on that, which just sucks. So I started to think about my job finding activities and how I'm looking at the roles I wanted and the tools I made to find those roles. And I started to think I should productize what I'm using. Now. I'll say straight out, obviously I haven't found that job yet, so I can't validate that the tools I'm making are all that effective. But here's my premise. Well, so I knew that. I realized after a while that I wanted to work for an early stage company.

Eric Zelman - **05:35**

So I started building scrapers and tools to scour VC firms and their investments. And I soon amassed several thousand companies basically that I wanted to be able to interrogate in terms of whether they would be a reasonable fit for me, whether they needed someone like me. And these were, you know, around the idea of finding early stage companies that might have been say pre, you know, like seed A or maybe B, but early on, because I think that my thing is like post customer life cycle. So whether that's support or customer success, that's kind of the space that I live in. So my whole thesis is, okay, I want to find an early stage company where I can get in really soon and build out the customer, the post sales, customer motion. And that would all be on me, right?

Eric Zelman - **06:37**

So that's, that's why I built this tool. What I started to realize was that I needed a way I had all these various requirements about what I wanted and what I thought a company should or shouldn't be, what would be a good fit for me. And I realized that it went way beyond like my resume and it started to just sort of take a life of its own in terms of the amount of data that I was collecting.

Eric Zelman - **07:07**

So I came up with this idea that basically for people who are looking at new opportunities, jobs perhaps, that you could have a structured text document that takes into account some aspects of their career history, some aspects of their resume, but also has a lot more things in it about how they like to work, the environments, the kinds of Businesses they work in, how they want to fit into those businesses, what businesses they don't want to work in, you know, what are their flags and on and on. And so what I built is a contraption. I was talking to someone earlier today who's from, who grew up in Portugal and he was like, what does contraption mean?

Eric Zelman - **08:04**

I'm like, so it's this weird machine that ingests stuff into a shovel fundamentally in my case venture portfolios or job site listings and then uses this text file that I've written to interrogate those businesses and figure out if they're a reasonable fit for me and whether I should pursue looking into them. And I did this because I'm lazy and I just don't want to look through 3,000 companies because it's just like, you know how it goes. It's just, it's just, it's awful and it's just mind numbing and just, it sucks. Okay, so there's my thesis. So let me, let me give you a little bit. Are you with me? Okay, cool. So, so what happens to all of this in my case, right?

Eric Zelman - **09:02**

Is that I made this file and I have these various scrapers that populate tool like airtable with just thousands of companies. And I've, and I built in a scoring system based on my criteria to give me a sense of would this be the right fit for me, right? What stage is it, how big is the company, what kind of products do they sell or what's their customer base? Are they an enterprise shop, are they focused on mid market? This is, mind you, all designed around me looking for a business to business SaaS, business that I want to work for, right? Employee counts funding when they were funded or when they first got their first funding and little things like what kind of customer Persona do they have?

Eric Zelman - **09:57**

If I'm going to get involved in the company, I need to know there's certain kinds of customer Personas that I'm not the right person, right? So like what would this be? I don't have experience working in government, right? So if you said, hey Eric, your job is like working on Graham's team for, you know, building government contracts or municipal contracts for lottery services. That's not a customer Persona that I'm familiar with, but I am familiar with like these sort of generic business users or maybe developers. So all of this logic that goes into this lives in a whole series of coded modules basically that I coded using Claude code and various AI tools and they live in an orchestration layer.

Eric Zelman - **10:55**

I don't know if you're familiar with it, but that's basically this layer where all this code runs and it can be scheduled to run. So these jobs run periodically and go find stuff for me. And I'm going at this backwards because that's just where my brain is taking me tonight. So what I'm looking for is, I'm looking to see if this is a, if this lens file that I created is something that would be useful for other people. Because I think that people, and you know, for myself include or myself. It starts with me. Right. Let me just show you what this thing looks like. I think that there are, I'll share this with you.

Eric Zelman - **11:48**

I think that there are people in their, in some point in their career where they are looking to sort of have a better

understanding of where they've been, where they're going, and whether or not the things ahead fit with that more so than just customizing a resume for a particular job over and over again. Right. Applying for jobs has basically become like this keyword bingo thing. Right. Because of ATS and things like that.

Graham - **12:23**

Yep.

Eric Zelman - **12:25**

So what my tool does is it takes things like their resumes, their LinkedIn profiles, pictures or could be artwork, it could even be video, could be, you know, TED talks they've given and basically sorts all this into an interrogated, sort of chatbot process where it takes all that content and then helps build out a structured document around what the, what you know, this profile of this individual. So for instance, in this particular profile here, which is a hypothetical profile for a person who's in customer success or some sort of, you know, customer facing role. It talks about what she's interested in, where she wants to be, what kinds of job functions she's comfortable in, what kinds of, what's her background? Right. Like how much money does she want to make?

Eric Zelman - **13:25**

What's her family situation, what cities would she want to work in or relocate to? What kinds of managers or leadership is she looking for? What size companies does she like or prefer? All this stuff. Right. That would never fit comfortably in a resume. What I'm thinking is that if I can build out this kind of a profile for a person that in some future version of what I have, there could be a way to align them where they could pick to say, you know, I'm Eric or I'm Sarah or I'm Graham and this is the kinds of things that I want to pursue and that the AI system can go find those things to Scrape or to get them feedback. I think that, you know, I'm.

Eric Zelman - **14:24**

I'm trying to stay away from building the job search sites like LinkedIn and things like that, because, I mean, those are massive and they exist and they have millions of jobs and things like that. What I don't think any of them do is this kind of deeper analysis or profiling of the user, because they're very much based on maybe even one that I saw recently, which got a lot of funding, is based on some very superficial stuff of uploading a resume and maybe a few text prompts of what you're looking for, and then it goes and tries to scour based on that stuff. I think that this evolves in another way as being a tool for companies to evaluate users or hires, right, to prevent bad hires.

Eric Zelman - **15:13**

I think that arguably that's probably at some point the biggest possible market for this, which is to be able to assemble a lot of material about someone and then be able to interrogate it with the lens that your company makes, which is an equally rich document about how they work, what their mission and values are, what their management structure is, like the personalities of that, maybe that department or that manager or that team, you know, to say, we've got 100 resumes or 500 people, does this fit? Is this the right fit? What are we looking for? Okay, so what does this all look like when it's done? So I have. Let's just share another screen with you. Hold your applause. Hang on a second as they navigate. Zoom here. So here's an example of hypothetical user reports.

Eric Zelman - **16:29**

Just a PDF where again, I took all that stuff that was in that text file and boiled it into a section about giving this person an overview. It's almost like a career version of your credit report, right? Because it's not your resume, but it's more of an overall profile about who you are. And again, or not again, this is all dependent on bringing in high quality stuff, right? So if you just do this process, throwing in a resume, there's not much to. There's not much to add. But if you go at this with rich methodology and how the tool interrogates you and how it looks at what you've done before and understand and helps to uncover where you want to go or what you're about, then this can be much richer.

Eric Zelman - **17:21**

And the kinds of things that I think that this could translate into, again, could be job finding for the user and then again, hypothetically, job or applicant matching for the company. So let me show you an example of Other. What do we got here? So I'll just go to this window here. So another thing could be I'm sharing the wrong window there, Graham. That's why this is. This is not. I'm going to get my demos down. That's probably step one. But let's go to the right window here. Yeah. Okay, so here we go. So here you could see someone having like a weekly briefing.

Eric Zelman - **18:17**

So this is the system using my profile from a few weeks ago, generating just a sample report of what it could look like if it knew all these things about me and it was looking at what's available for roles. It can start to dig into things and show a lot more detail about why something is a fit for you. Then, then, you know, most or likely all job boards would do. Okay, so where am I going with this? Let's go to a couple slides here. So let me just give you the overview and then I'll ask you the ask, which is basically to test out the intake form. So let's do this. Let's go through this and I'm going backwards. So it's about signal matching, it's about coming to figure out.

Eric Zelman - **19:11**

The more data that you put in, I think the more authentic the person is. I think that, you know, we've all done these work assessments before where people game the system, right? So they're like your boss gives you know, the

management team comes in and said, we want to profile people, we want to understand how you work. And we're going to do these personality assessments or whatever that is, and everyone comes at it and they all put in what they think the company wants them to be, right, to be the most successful at the role at that moment, but it isn't necessarily them. Right? And how that, what that looks like when you step away from your role is different from when you're actually in it. So I think that's an important aspect to it.

Eric Zelman - **19:58**

So the first things that go into this are about helping someone gather their materials, LinkedIn, writing samples, assessments, all this stuff, right? Nothing's required, but the more you put in, the more it puts out. The intake form takes about 25 to 45 minutes of conversation with the chatbot for it to flesh all this out. And then at the end there's a feedback form. So I think that the ask for anyone is about 50 minutes or so. In this, in this round of testing, you can put in text files, PDFs, I think you can put in pictures. I haven't tried video, but it might work. Someone wanted to put in audio that probably would work as well. I don't have a good LinkedIn sucker, so scraper, because LinkedIn's pretty guarded about or has a lot of tools to make it hard to do that.

Eric Zelman - **20:53**

So I think it would be interesting for people to put in comments, you know, recommendations and things like that to flesh out more of their personality. I think the most important stuff here is honestly the things that come from assessments. One of the things I didn't mention is that the genesis of why this worked for me is that I've spent, I don't know, a few thousand dollars over the last nine months with two different career coaches. And for me that was really valuable. And that netted out a lot of material about what I want, what I think, how I work. That stuff in some way might come from assessment documents that people have in their own lives. So, you know, again, I know not everyone has done that.

Eric Zelman - **21:40**

I think that in some sort of future state of this, I think that this tool works best, might work best. This is a, this is just a guess when it's coach driven versus being something that people just sort of throw stuff into. But that isn't necessarily the most critical thing. But basically anything that's a picture or text, PDF, Word documents, PowerPoints, all that stuff should be able to be ingested and the more you can tell it about yourself. Like I was talking to Brendan earlier this evening and he's like, well, I haven't looked at my resume since due to 2019. And I was saying to him, you know, like, let's see what happens if you put information about like your, you know, stuff about Crestar, right? Like you're putting your heart and soul into this business. You know, like let.

Eric Zelman - **22:30**

Feed it information about Crestor, feed it information about your boating projects. You know, what do you like to do? How does this, how does, how do you see yourself in the world? So the guided discovery process, let's jump to that slide. These slides are a little wonky, has about eight sections. This could be shortened. This sections kind of

overlap. So, you know, I'm not trying to overthink that at the moment. I'm really just trying to say, is this a viable concept? Right? So at the end of this, it's going to create a file. That file will be something that then I can build prototype PDFs, sample reports and things like that. I'm trying to get a feel for whether this helps people find out new information. Like does this tool represent you Better than a resume. Would you.

Eric Zelman - **23:30**

If, if a recruiter was using a tool like this, would it be useful to share with them? I could see scenarios where a company uses this internally for internal candidates or maybe external candidates. Did any of this surface anything new about yourself? Was anything particularly valuable? Was something's weak? Is anything missing? Would anyone ever pay for something like this? So these are kind of my, this is like 1.0. But these are my basic questions because yeah, I'm thinking about this as is this a problem that needs to be solved? So I'm also talking with a couple of HR people. It's interesting.

Eric Zelman - **24:15**

My father in law, I think I mentioned before, Alyssa's dad has done all this investment work over the years and he lives in this like community in Florida where he just runs into all sorts of like other retired people who are in business and. Well, this isn't the only person I'm speaking to in this, in this space. He told me last week that his, one of his, one of he and Nancy and my mother's mother in law, they're one of their best friends in Florida is this woman named Edith Hunt who was the head of recruiting at Goldman Sachs for like 30 years. And I was like, that's amazing, right? Because they may not be the customer. They may not. You know, she's retired. She's been retired for 13 years.

Eric Zelman - **25:00**

But I was like, she must know a ton about whether this is a real problem in the world, you know, of understanding what we're getting for candidates and how they submit their materials. So I don't know, I'm just looking for feedback. I've also asked our Edith, she might have some skills in it. And I'm asking all of our friends like Rich and Niels and Jeremy and then people I've worked with, people who have been in similar roles than me. There's a guy who I worked with for many years, for about 10 years who had a similar role at Bigtin Can. He resigned the end of March. And Ravi is also interested in working for a startup. And so Ravi can see himself using this tool because he's doing almost the exact same job search I am.

Eric Zelman - **25:55**

But that's like, you know, later in the thinking of this because what the actual tools use, the job search, whether you want to work for VC or big company, what goes into that shovel that this thing would look at is, you know, later does. It's not that important.

Graham - **26:19**

Yep. Okay. So, and how are you. So you're talking to friends about It.

Eric Zelman - **26:36**

Yeah.

Graham - **26:37**

You've developed a tool, I guess you want me to try it, is that right?

Eric Zelman - **26:45**

Yeah. So what I'd love is in the next week if you could put Aside, you know, 45 minutes or so to give it a shot to walk through it. To walk through. This is the intake form and that's basically this 1.0 version of the intake form. And I want to see if the output of the intake form is producing something close or giving me feedback about how to create a minimum viable product. I think that in the future I could envision this being like a free tool and maybe then there could be some premium version of it. But basically I want to get as many people using this as possible. There are all kinds of steps that would have to happen to make that doable because this all resides within tools that I pay for monthly.

Eric Zelman - **27:43**

And I can't scale it up right to support hundreds or thousands of people, but I can definitely try dozens. One of the other things about this is that there's a logic step in terms of this idea of. Multiple. So there's a bi directional analysis happening in that could happen between a company and a user and that logic of this, what I see this going to bi directional process where the user has created a lens document and that the company has a lens document for the role and that the two are used in conjunction to see how they match that.

Eric Zelman - **28:32**

I've patent, I've filed a provisional patent on that last week and in hopes that AI can protect that because it seemed

from the AI searches I've done and other things that it was sort of unique and that it gives me about it, you know, and if that's true that it's unique, it gives me about a year to flesh this out before I'd actually try to get a real patent even if you know, and it may not be viable as a product. So I may not ever do that.

Eric Zelman - **29:03**

But for me that was like a milestone to know that the, that even in light of the enormous companies that are doing resume scraping all the time, the ATS systems of like companies like Ashby and Rippling and Lever and you know, all these shops, I mean because you know, like, I mean maybe you do know may you remember or maybe you have seen this. It' out of the 120 resumes that I've submitted, 90% of them went through these major HR hosting sites. You know, no one has their own form. They're all these generic forms and they all use that ATS system Where you're just asked to do bingo in your resume.

Graham - **29:48**

Yep.

Eric Zelman - **29:48**

And, and I think that this creates a more indelible image of the user versus did Graham bring an optimized resume and to submit that.

Graham - **30:04**

Yeah, I mean so just speaking like not really thinking about this. I mean one is like I found this coach several years ago and what they said was, What they said is the system's broken. And they said at one point in the past people would advertise in the newspaper. People looking at it were from sort of a small group and therefore you had a limited applicant pool. They said now you get this national like level applicant pool, maybe even international level applicant pool. Everyone's filling out a million things. Everything's like being fed through AI and there aren't like good way. Companies are still struggling to find people and people are struggling to find jobs.

Eric Zelman - **31:05**

Yeah, yeah.

Graham - **31:06**

So what this company did was they, I mean essentially what they like they created a LinkedIn reach out engine which I think is illegal technically or against Linked. It's not illegal, it's against LinkedIn's rules. But in a set, well, in a sense what they said is create a few things or maybe they did a few things. So one is they worked on sort of mindset, a little bit of being positive and things like that. One was being getting your materials ready. So having a resume like a LinkedIn page, things like that, sort of best practices like posting. And then they had this engine which would help you would use, I forgot what it's called, LinkedIn Navigator or something like that. But you'd use LinkedIn Navigator and you'd put in stuff and it would help you automate, like reach out to people.

Graham - **32:23**

And then their idea was you do a lot of conversations and if you kind of follow this script of saying like what do you need and how are you going about it or whatever, I, I forgot the exact questions that you could then create conversations, get into interviews and then move from there. So their whole methodology was. And I, I've seen this, there's another book called the Two Hour Job Search. And their whole premise in a sense is similar to yours. The guy works at MBA recruiting places. But what they are trying to do, what they said, write a short message, sort of have it customized, have it be something that the person would be interested in and, but also filter companies based on your requirements. So very quickly like create a 40 company list. And I sort of forgot the methodology.

Graham - **33:34**

But it was an interesting book. But this guy said don't even apply to companies online. And he said you can do it. But actually, I mean, this guy's at Duke MBA program, so smart people. He said, a lot of people do it. They send out hundreds of things. Like, you just said a 4% return rate. So you've. I forgot how many jobs you said you applied to. 130 Jobs or something.

Eric Zelman - **34:00**

Yeah.

Graham - **34:02**

So 4% of that is gonna be like, I don't know, five or six responses. And like, from my experience, like, I had the same thing, like, applied to a bunch of jobs. Most of them you hear nothing from. And then a few of them, you hear something like, you know, thanks for your time. You're not the right fit. And occasionally I get something which is, yeah, let's have a conversation.

Eric Zelman - **34:33**

And that's. That 4 or 5%. That's the, like, where I'd had interviews, you know, I mean.

Graham - **34:39**

Okay, so you're saying 4 or 5% positive, correct?

Eric Zelman - **34:43**

Correct.

Graham - **34:44**

Okay, yeah. Because I would say, like, my whole thing was maybe 5% response rate. So, yeah, say like, no, thank you. They just. It was just like a black hole.

Eric Zelman - **34:56**

I mean, I think my. I think the response rate is more like, generally speaking, because I get the automated responses weeks later, you know, So, I mean, it's not like I'm getting human sending, saying, no, thank you. But eventually I'd say 50 of them, 60% send them. I actually use, you know, I. I track all of that in. In airtable. So as I get mail coming in and out, it. It registers whether or not it's a rejection. So I can just cross it off the list. So I like to kind of overanalyze a lot of stuff. I don't have answers to those. Those things. I mean. So first off, I think that I don't have hard numbers on this, but I've done dozens of cold outreaches on LinkedIn. Very few of them get responses at all. So LinkedIn, InMails, Connects, whatever.

Eric Zelman - **35:51**

Whether I wrote them from the heart or I used AI or I, you know, it. It doesn't really matter, people, if you don't. If they. If you're not within their circle, people don't necessarily respond. So I think that's a real reality. And I don't think that I could make a tool that necessarily conquers that. On the LinkedIn side of what you're saying, there's a companion. I was saying to Brendan that although I'm using this, if you say, give me a tool that uses AI to farm job Opportunities, right? That's the same basic premise as a whole suite of tools that are used by salespeople for finding leads. It's the same exact tool.

Eric Zelman - **36:39**

And so, you know, I met with a founder of a startup, I don't know, like a month or two ago, guys got a small shop, but he's got one of these tools and there are a lot of things like this. It's an AI tool that gets rid of your whole front line of salespeople. So basically what it does is he's got 250 million. You know, again, this is question of data quality, I don't know, but he's got 250 million verified LinkedIn people. And what he does basically is you throw in all your information about your product and your segment and you train the AI and you know, it sort of interrogates you and walks you through this and then it starts doing outbound cold calling for you versus having to have people do it. Right.

Eric Zelman - **37:22**

And, and then I've also met with companies that do again, because I'm also looking for a job because, you know, this isn't like, how is this going to pay for. But you know, there are other companies that do things higher up in the food chain, like, oh, if you get a lead, they use AI to route them to the right. Right. Salespeople make sure you don't lose your leads, make sure they don't fall out of, you know, because CRMs are kind of black holes sometimes. So. But I, I think that where my value is and where this value, where this point of value is, this very small piece, because I don't think that I want to build a job scraper. I don't think I'm going to be building the whole end to end workflow. Like, here's where you track your jobs.

Eric Zelman - **38:09**

Here's the thing that helps coach you through writing your resume. Here's the thing that helps, I mean, I have a friend who I used to work with who's like, were sort of thinking about collaborating and we realized is that I'm in the discovery, like very early, like discovery of a tool that helps you figure out who the F you are, right? Because you're like, you've got your resume, but there's more to you than that. And then there's the, okay, put it in action, right? And there's this whole middle ground of the process of, as you said, of contacting people via LinkedIn or tracking your resumes and all these tools for that. And then there's a Whole nother set of tools if you get a bite that go through coaching on interviews and all that.

Eric Zelman - **38:51**

And I, it's, there's an enormous number of things you could do. I'm trying to just narrow this down to this very much more basic. Well, not necessarily basic, but this, this deeper, richer profiling of the user and then, and then a companion profiling opportunity or thought process around companies and leaving the whole middle in between for what it is. One of the things that I prototype, I didn't bring it up but like I have a tool where you could take a hypothetical company and a hypothetical folder of 50 users and basically using this methodology, using sliders to basically say depending on how you, what your values are within your company of like, you know, if you value technology over people, management over whatever, you can start to zoom in and zoom out on candidates that fit what you're looking for.

Eric Zelman - **40:05**

So what am I trying to solve? So I think that the, the opportunity is the novelty of a system that does bidirectional multivariable matching between job seekers and companies.

Graham - **40:26**

Okay. So just a couple, maybe a few things. So one is, I basically understand it, but I also don't fully understand it. And I think what might help there. Well, one is trying it. The other one is having a little bit of a deck of what are the problems people are trying to solve, companies are trying to solve, what are the solutions and then how does yours fit in?

Eric Zelman - **41:07**

Sure. So, because that's a great question.

Graham - **41:13**

Yep. So, so there's a little bit of, in that pitch of if seeing it.

Eric Zelman - **41:24**

So, so I, this is a couple weeks old, but I, you know, again, I'm just spitting stuff out using Claude. So this is a, and just thinking about what a prototype of an investor deck would look like. So the problem pipeline. So job 74% are false positive matches via ATS filtering. 85% Of desirable roles are filled through networks before they get to job boards. The idea of a structured document through AI guided or coach facilitated. There's an opportunity here for coaches to use this tool to guide users. So I would say that the process you're going to walk through when the chatbot is built off of conversations I've had with one particular coach. You could have a whole different set of materials and methodologies that the chat bot could use based on a different coach's methodology.

Eric Zelman - **42:19**

And coaches have a huge, have a very difficult time getting customers who want to pay $200 an hour. Right. So there's A whole market potentially out there for people who want their coaching skill distilled in a chatbot fundamentally and be able to pick those Personas or what fits them in a marketplace for that. And that the lens governs a scoring pipeline that identifies opportunities against identity signals. So the pipeline could be again, anything. I'm not trying to define right now what that is. I built one for me. But in a real product, it could grow to be totally different set of VC concerns. I mean, the VCs I'm scraping are focused around particular sets of products like B2B SaaS, Enterprise Healthcare. Right, SaaS Healthcare. Someone else might be interested in consumer

product led growth. They might be interested in financial.

Eric Zelman - **43:30**

You know, there's just so many different possibilities.

Graham - **43:34**

I would still say simplify it more. Like, I mean, I get the idea that you're, I mean, so I had two things. So one is like, exactly. Like, yeah, I get the big, I get the or from this. Like the takeaway is there's a big problem in that ATS systems don't really work and people have trouble finding companies. Now the question is there are tons of systems out there that there are tons of coaches. What. So I mean, I guess there are several things. One is methodology. Like, I like the fact that you're trying to develop something. I think one is trying to get a better idea of what the product position is. So saying, like, I mean, you just mentioned several ATS systems to me. So companies use these ATS systems. This issue still exists.

Graham - **44:34**

Now one of the questions you might want to ask a coach, like there might be coaches and I'm sure there are coaches that sort of automate things. I mean a lot of. I've worked with several coaches and they're like, okay, you know, fill out these documents about kind of what you like or whatever, and then they kind of review them and they kind of give you something. But what I've sort of feel about a lot of things is and this goes back to even the NBA, it's like people go to NBA programs to try to figure out what they want to do and do something different necessarily. But everyone at that point, like, and these are like 27, 28 year olds for the most part they are already saying like, you've done this and this, this is what you are.

Graham - **45:20**

And I had a friend that worked for amex and he worked there for a bunch of years, let's say 10 years. And while there, let's say he worked in five different roles. And so he worked like in BD and in marketing and da da da. And he would talk to people and very quickly they'd be like, okay, so you're a BD guy. And I found that in talking to people like very quickly they have, they sort of want to just say like how do I make this extremely simple? So like they'll just say like Eric is, I even forgot like field service, customer support or something like that or technical customer supporter or whatever. They, they very quickly want sort of a role of who you are and that's how they identify it.

Graham - **46:20**

And when I listen to people, I often think they don't really fully understand who I am. But I also realize like they're busy and they don't even have time to fully realize who I am.

Eric Zelman - **46:32**

I think that those things, I think those things are absolutely true. I think that, what to say, I think that. So I think that in that there are a lot of people who have very quick judgments on hiring. So one of the coaches I work with who is interesting, he's very empathic, he's very much in the personal journey kind of person versus the street. Like I had two coaches. One coach I had was a guy in his 60s who was a healthcare C level person for years and years in different companies, healthcare, insurance, had a military background. I picked him because I wanted to find someone who was least like me and most like the vc, most like the PE firm that bought the company that I was in before I was laid off.

Eric Zelman - **47:23**

And I got him because I was trying to navigate how to, how does Eric Zellin live in a pe buyout world, right? Because they're just nasty people and it isn't my style of how it worked. And so I needed to coach for like trying to maintain the job I had. Not necessarily finding a job, right. But I moved to a different coach in November, October, November. A guy in the UK who is much more on the, let's figure out like more about like who you are and what you really want to do versus the performative. Here's what you need to do to survive in the last role that you were in kind of thing, you know. And so I, I think that there's different reasons, there are different coaches.

Eric Zelman - **48:16**

But the second coach, the reason I bring this up is that he said to me, he's like, I have so many customers right now who in looking at this, he thought this tool is useful for someone at mid career who's just wondering how do they take stock in it and where they want to go next. He also thought that he knows a lot of people who would never use this because the market has so many people looking for jobs right now that if they make a bad hire, it's painful, but there's so many more people they can hire that they just move on. Which, you know, is discouraging. I don't think it necessarily means that there's no opportunity here. I just don't think that this is necessarily a thing that it's going to fit everyone.

Eric Zelman - **48:57**

I mean, I've had plenty of managers who would look at this and be like, just like you said that the people just sort of want to sort you into a quick, you know, sorting hat. And it's like I spent 10 minutes figuring out what this person's about or five minutes figuring out what this person's about and that's where they're going to go. I've known lots of people like that over the years. But at the same time I think that as an individual looking for a job, I think that something like this is powerful for me in terms of crafting what my resume, my cover letter is and kind of figuring out, hey, you know, I want to be an early stage startup. I'm more of a builder mentality. So I mean, I think it's equally like a self discovery tool.

Eric Zelman - **49:36**

You know, Brendan looked at this and he's like, oh, this is what colors your parachute. You know that book from the 70s, right?

Graham - **49:45**

Yeah, yeah. And there, I mean there are a trillion versions of that. And I, I agree with you. Like not everyone needs to use it, I think. So these are the things that I think would make sense before trying it for you. One is I would think about this in relation to your job search. So what I heard you say is you're still looking for a job at the same time you're trying to productize this. One of the things I've sort of thought, like I took some classes on what it's called Coursera and there were Google people. And all the Google people like self introduced themselves and they're like, yeah, I developed a website to do X, Y or Z or I was doing like this small business.

Graham - **50:34**

And so my sort of takeaway from Google people was they're not just smart people, they're people that have smart people who have done something. So to me and I've heard with a job search and like I've sort of lived it. I mean, I sort of, I mean I now Sort of describe myself as retired, actually. And I don't know if I have enough money to retire. I don't know a lot of things, like, definitely don't have enough money to send my kids to college in the US So there are a lot of things. But I realized, like, for a long time I was somewhat desperate about finding a job.

Eric Zelman - **51:13**

Yeah.

Graham - **51:14**

And I found three things and they all really sucked. And I was someone who like would have said one of my strengths is I can work with anyone. And I feel like I found like three toxic environments.

Eric Zelman - **51:26**

Yeah.

Graham - **51:26**

Anyway, one of the things during the job search, like this two hour job search, which I thought was an amazing book, but they basically said you don't need to do the job search all day. You may do four hours a day or something like that, or three hours a day. And this other coaching class, it's like, yeah, you get some reach out. You reach out to some people, you apply to some companies, you may have some interviews or whatever, but you can do other things.

Graham - **51:56**

So if you said to yourself, I'm going to spend four hours a day looking for a job and I'm going to spend four hours a day on this, and I'm just making this up because it could be two hours or it could be eight or whatever, then what I would say is, can you figure out how to use this tool to help you on your job search? And so.

Eric Zelman - **52:19**

And I'm absolutely doing that. So I'm using it to find my job while I'm building it. Like I'm building it, I'm flying the plane while I'm building it. And that's been the whole thing all along. They are really the same thing.

Graham - **52:32**

Okay. So, yeah, I mean, what I was just gonna, I mean what I was basically gonna say is in doing that, like, if I took that approach, which I, I still think networking is a good approach, but it's like I'm going to reach out to, I don't know, 25 career coaches. And part of it I'm going to ask them, like, I'm not, maybe you need a career coach, maybe you don't. And maybe this is a good idea, maybe it's not. But I'm going to reach out to 25 career coaches and I'm going to ask them about the tools they use and how they help people and what they actually do. And then I'm going to reach out to 25 people in HR.

Graham - **53:18**

Now, to make it more specific, maybe you take your tool and say, these are the Companies I want to work at, and you reach out to the people, and maybe you do it as a job applicant, but maybe you do it as a tool person. So maybe you say, like, I'm trying to get a better understanding of what tools do you have? You know, I've looked up, you know, I've done this because of your company. But one of the things that comes across with the conversation, which is just about you, is one, you're building something, and two, you're very process focused. So you don't come across as someone who's just like, you know, hey, dude, do we have the right fit? It's more and maybe more the way an artist would, but more of, you know, I'm trying to filter these things down.

Graham - **54:16**

This is what I've done. And if you can leverage it to get closer to those companies, that may be helpful. So maybe

career coaches aren't the right people. Maybe. I mean, maybe the other thing is you try to find out who works at these companies and you ask them, you just ask them a little bit about their companies and how they went about finding the roles, and that's sort of a way for you to improve your networking or whatever.

Eric Zelman - **54:49**

I think that. So, I mean, sometimes it's. Yeah, no, I think those are all really good points. Some of it is pretty obvious because you know that when you're applying for a job and they're. They're paying Rippling to host their job site, you know, like, there it is. Right. So that's what I was saying is that job, you know, they're all subdomains of these four or five ATS resume companies.

Graham - **55:17**

Yeah, but that's not the problem. Like, that's the landscape in a sense. So I would say the problem is that the ATS doesn't work that well. And so you can figure, like, you could guess that these companies, like, I don't know anything about Rippling, but these companies are all probably trying to do a similar thing of saying, I mean, I'm gonna just make the assumption, probably tons of companies are like, we're not necessarily giving them a good group of people to interview.

Eric Zelman - **55:55**

Right. So you have to say, yeah, how do you attract them to go to fill out that form? Right. How do you draw them? How are you, how are they finding you in the mess of all the possible places they could apply? Why are they applying to your company And.

Graham - **56:11**

Well, yeah, I mean, I, I think for a Lot of it. It's like a company posts something on LinkedIn. As you said, a lot of the things are already filled. So a lot of people said posted jobs aren't useful. But then they get, I mean, right now I would guess, I mean, I revise my resume sometimes and sometimes I did it for a role and it's like, I don't know, I wasn't successful, so maybe I don't understand the concept of it. But you know, I might spend an hour or two to customize my, to like change my resume so that it included a few different roles and maybe slightly different, but I don't think it was necessarily that good. And then I would send it in and not get a response.

Graham - **56:55**

And so it's like the other way of doing it was just don't customize at all, just send in, just submit something. So spend 15 minutes trying to fill out like what I needed to do and just submit stuff. But I think like, what happens now is for a certain role, like a company might get 2,000 resumes.

Eric Zelman - **57:17**

Exactly.

Graham - **57:18**

And so they have to use this thing. And then the question is, what is it about the system? So one, like I could see there's just a challenge in, there's a challenge in model. Like how do you figure out who's a good person? I mean, maybe they have the ability to say who got hired if they have that and then they can sort of do like a data science project.

Eric Zelman - **57:50**

Yeah, I mean, they, I mean from talking to hiring managers and from my experience of my last role where I certainly wasn't filtering through 2000 resumes, but talking to recruiters that I know, and the way I understand it basically is that the ATS system is to, is sort of like a filling out an rfp. Right. They're looking for where you say no. Right. Then if you say no, then they can pull you out. So they filter out all the no's. The ATS filters out everyone by keywords and keyword compliance. So there are lots of websites now that basically rank your resume. And so, I mean, and you can do this in any AI system. But basically what it does is that it takes your resume, takes the JD and then basically creates a score of how well they match each other.

Eric Zelman - **58:42**

And while I'm doing scoring, my point is that this is a very shallow scoring because it basically means that if Erica Graham has an AI based resume and we keyword the F out of our resume or something approximate to that. Right. Maybe that doesn't sound completely like a Lie. But, you know, we've put in 80% of the keywords. That's our way of getting over the threshold to getting a human being to potentially read it. So they get 2,000 resumes, and frankly, at this point, I don't know anyone who doesn't use. I mean, most people really just do this. So they get 2000 resumes, a thousand of them or 1700 of them get knocked out, then they have to go through those next 300. And I think the question that we're both asking is, what happens then? How do you.

Eric Zelman - **59:37**

How do you make it a productive experience for the HR team who might have multiple roles to figure out? How do I validate 300 people for the next round and not pull her hair out?

Graham - **59:51**

Yeah, and I mean, I've heard that they spend like two minutes per resume or something or five minutes per resume. Like, they just sort of fly through it. And they're just looking for, like, keywords, too.

Eric Zelman - **01:00:03**

And they don't pay them a lot. I mean, they hire really junior people that when you do get through this, the. Everything is the sort of race to the bottom. So it's not like you're getting an experienced HR person. So if you're. If your title and your experience doesn't line up exactly what they anticipate, they don't. They don't have the career experience to be able to understand your resume unless you're the exact fit that they were told they're looking for, you know. So it. So, you know, and. And I think that's. I think this sort of. I was thinking about this. Alyssa was, like, saying, like, about how many blown. How many. The difference this year in Major League Baseball with the. The. The automated strike system. Right.

Graham - **01:00:51**

Yep.

Eric Zelman - **01:00:52**

And how many umps are getting overruled? How many calls are getting over? Like, the other day, the Yankees, like, overruled, like, five. Five decisions based on the automated system. Because the umps are always wrong. And I'm not saying that umps are the same thing as the underpaid HR people, but, you know, I think that there's room for improvement in that system.

Graham - **01:01:17**

Yet. No, there's definitely room for improvement. That. That is a given. It's just. What is it about your. Like, this is. This, again, goes like. So the problem is that. And. And again, like, in a sense, it becomes the target. So are you. Are you right now, like, the way you're talking, it sounds more like the company view, but.

Eric Zelman - **01:01:43**

Well, I think it's.

Graham - **01:01:44**

What is it? Like, I mean, someone could say we want a second tool. So they say we use rippling or kipling or whatever it's called to get through. We get through 2007, 2000 resumes, we get down to 300 and then we use the second tool because it's actually proven to be more useful, but it's not as scalable.

Eric Zelman - **01:02:05**

Exactly.

Graham - **01:02:06**

Or something like that.

Eric Zelman - **01:02:07**

Exactly.

Graham - **01:02:09**

And then, you know, this one actually it scrapes everyone's public data from Instagram and da, da, da. And somehow like, I mean this again is part of it. It's like what's the decision maker in that?

Eric Zelman - **01:02:26**

And I mean I think that, I mean you can look at it that way, but I'd also sort of impart this. I mean it doesn't necessarily answer your question, but I put this on the side. It's like coaching is valuable to me because until I did coaching and this is going to sound really like, you know, like I did therapy now I know who I am, but I think that I didn't have. And granted I'm still looking for a role, but I think if I hadn't done a lot of coaching recently or the last year, I think I would be way off in terms of what I was thinking about in terms of what would make me happy and how to articulate my value to a company. And so by having a better sense of myself, it gives me, I think a much more.

Eric Zelman - **01:03:08**

And granted, I know I'm still looking a much stronger position of saying here's what I'm really good at and here's where I would be a good fit and where it's where I'm not a good fit, you know, and knowing that versus just wasting my time sending out thousands of resumes to random places based on a vague sense of whatever I've done based on my resume alone. Know what I mean?

Graham - **01:03:30**

But, but how do you. So the question maybe that comes down to it is how do you know that so you know more about yourself now.

Eric Zelman - **01:03:38**

Yeah.

Graham - **01:03:40**

So is knowing more about yourself. Like I want to work for a venture like a venture backed series A Series B startup.

Eric Zelman - **01:03:48**

Yep. And, and it's other stuff that went into the lens. Like for instance, I've got a whole bunch of disqualifiers like look like it goes through and looks at all the companies and says, you know what? Eric doesn't want to work for a P for private equity owned shops. So I've got like of those 3,000, there goes, you know, 2,000 of them because they're or whatever A thousand of them because they're PE backed or that they, between the time that the venture firm published their announcement and today because some of these venture firms portfolios list companies that they invested in 2010. Right. So 16 years later changes and that company was sold or whatever.

Eric Zelman - **01:04:38**

So there's a lot of enrichment that has to go on in these pipelines for this to all play out, you know, to be able to take whatever I'm thinking I want and for it to be articulated by, you know, analysis against these companies. Like, is this gonna, is this company? So for instance, I've got another pipeline here that does. So I was talking with VC

firms live, another one that basically goes through and interrogates job boards. And it's the same logic, but it then looks at the roles and then figures out, you know, if anything good comes along. Like, is it a job I want? Is it, you know, what are the flags? Like, okay, it wants me to move to Louisville. That's not going to fit for me,.

Graham - **01:05:31**

You know, or yeah, I, I, and I, I don't know, like how much, I don't know how much the criteria, I mean it still seems in a sense filter based. And that may be enough of saying like, okay, yeah, I see in the thing it says move to Louisville, like exclude it because I don't want to relocate or something or remote or Boston, you know, Boston, Providence area or something like that.

Eric Zelman - **01:06:05**

Like I have a whole list of, you know, cities and, and types of roles or sectors that I want to work in or sectors that would be like hard stops or skills I have or don't have, you know. So I mean, there's a lot of fuzziness to the system. It's not like it's different from, I think a lot of the ways that job search engines have worked in the past where it was very, I mean, literal keyword strings. There's a lot of fuzziness to it. And you can kind of dial that in and out depending on how myopic you want to be.

Graham - **01:06:43**

Yep.

Eric Zelman - **01:06:44**

So this is the, this, this slide basically is the core of what I want to file a provisional patent on. This idea of does the opportunity fit me, does the candidate fit us? And then a kind of mix of variables that could be used to score the individual and score the company. And then I think this might speak, I hope this speaks to some of the things that we're sort of getting at. Like this is what the marketplace looks like a little bit. Right. I mean this is very brief. But you've got things like ats, right? I mentioned rippling. It's not on that list, but that's one of those companies. And it's like, okay, keyword overlap, pass, fail, screening, right? There's no patent or any kind of intellectual, hard intellectual property on these ATS systems.

Eric Zelman - **01:07:44**

What I know of disc, just strengths, finder and disc, those kinds of coach led or HR led, you know, rich discovery things. They're useful, they create a profile report. But you know, it's, there's no, it's self reporting and there's no directionality in it. So there's a company called Jack and Jill that I've been using for job finding, which is really cool. It's a great AI system and actually found a few jobs that I've applied to. So I mean, I'm really impressed by it. I think

it's the closest thing to a competitor to me. They just got 20 million in funding. And what they do is they do wide, but they don't do deep. So they claim to have, I don't know, 10 or 20 million jobs that they can align you to. And they ask you.

Eric Zelman - **01:08:45**

There's a conversational process similar to what I'm building, but they don't build a rich profile on the idea of having this again, this indelible, like, who is Graham? They're much more superficial. So they're like, hey, Graham, upload your resume and tell us a few things about yourself. So it's interesting because they have a lot of the foundational pieces and certainly a ton of money. I mean, I'm just vibe coding this. And I wonder, right? I mean, I, I, I go back and forth with this all the time of like, am I making a bad assumption? Because if These guys have $20 million and they're not doing what I'm doing, they could do what I'm doing. But maybe it's just not valuable to anyone. So I'm always fascinated to know, like, why did they choose what they did? You know, what was the decision process?

Eric Zelman - **01:09:40**

Am I going down the wrong road? But yeah, I mean, people spend a lot of money on coaching platforms. According to, again, you know, take this with AI, 4 billion in coaching platforms, you know, the acquisition marketplaces with $35 billion worth of software. So what were think what I and my AI were thinking about three different entry points, like job seekers, like a free version, maybe a version that then has a scoring pipeline for particular jobs or industries. I don't know, there could be an opportunity for a coach methodology embedded into this where a coach says I'm going to sign up with you.

Eric Zelman - **01:10:34**

And then maybe they're an affiliate or something like that because I want to have a lower cost way of getting to my customer, getting users in a marketplace because they're just doing one ones for $200 an hour and you can pay for that. And then the third one, like I was saying, is this idea of enterprise hiring and this bi directional process of, you know, we look at the user, they look at us and, and I haven't seen. And from what I understand, what I've. The research I've done so far, there isn't any that hasn't, that bi directional process hasn't been exploited in the marketplace. And, and what I'm trying to figure out is why, you know, is it a bad idea?

Graham - **01:11:24**

So when you say bidirectional, can you explain that again?

Eric Zelman - **01:11:28**

Yeah, so what I was saying before is this bi directional. So you build your lens. Graham. Okay. And company XYZ builds their lens and then when you're looking at a role, right may it's role specific, say you were even within that company and they're thinking we want to promote you or move you to a different division or a group of people. This could be anything. This could be a group of people and another group of people. And you're wondering, would this, how would this team work together? What are some things we can anticipate by this combination? So what I'm trying to do is build a structured document that allows analysis of these two different entities, an individual and a company, to ascertain whether they have a reasonable fit.

Eric Zelman - **01:12:20**

And what are some of the things that you can glean or understand from how the, from how that works, from the outcome of that. And if you put junk in, you get junk out. But if you put rich stuff in, like a lot of stuff, I think you get something else. When I was showing this todd, so Todd, the first coach I had, he's done disc assessments for years. And I'm very, very, I mean, you know, like, you know me, I'm totally like, I don't believe in 90% of this stuff. I had done disc assessments, it turns out, twice before over the last 25 or 30 years. The other two times I think I just threw them out, but I think I found them somewhere buried in my hard drive or on my laptop or in cloud or something like that.

Eric Zelman - **01:13:15**

And I was like, oh, this is Garbage. When I did a disc assessment with Todd in like, I don't know, June, July. And I was. Just had my guard down and I just did the thing right, and I wasn't trying to game it. I was just, like, going along with it. And then he scored it. The report that I got back was so much more aligned. I mean, and it wasn't that we had. He and I had talked about many of these things, but it really was unearthed through the report. So many of those things about my work Persona, my private Persona, my insecurities, my style, all stuff came out from that. And I was like, oh, that's really amazing. And that.

Eric Zelman - **01:13:53**

That information actually, I think, has been really valuable for me in building out this way of looking at where's a good fit for me, what isn't a good fit for me. You know, I mean, sometimes it's pretty binary. Like, I want to be, you know, I want to. I don't want to be in charge of the whole, you know, renewal pipeline for a company. Right. I'm happy to have a number, but I don't. I want to be part of a team that has a number versus the, you know, an account manager. Right. I mean, some things are binary like that, and you just know that, or I don't work for pe, but a lot of this other stuff is kind of in. Is in between, is. Is fuzzy stuff. And.

Eric Zelman - **01:14:38**

And I think that stuff is important to know if you're thinking about, I want to bring someone on my team or I want to

hire someone, I've got these 30 people. What's it going to be like? How do they like to be managed? You know, And I was talking to Louis, guy who worked for me for several years and who actually is still there and kind of doing my. My old job. And Louis and I were talking about, like, Louis is very good at interviewing people. He's. He's great. He's a great interviewer. And he's asked really revealing, you know, tough questions like, know. And he's. He's done a lot of interviews, and it's great, and I've learned a lot from him. But again, at scale, there's only so much that you can do, only so many questions Lewis can ask.

Eric Zelman - **01:15:21**

And so it's like, if you can build a portfolio of someone's, like, for instance, there are a lot of resumes that we got where people would say they knew how to do something, and then we'd say, okay, well, we're in a zoom session. Show us that, you know, what that really means, you know, we'd ask them follow up questions and things like that. I think that obviously you can create almost anything with AI, but I think that having a portfolio tied to a resume shows a lot more. And I think that we don't have processes like that when applying for jobs. Jobs are like, I want your resume, I might ask you a couple questions and I want a cover letter or I don't even need a cover letter. I mean, that's why I'm like, this is so broken.

Eric Zelman - **01:16:10**

I've seen so many senior VP level jobs where they're just like, send me a resume, you know, and it's out of frustration, right, Because I'm like, I want to have a conversation with them. But like, you know, I mean, just think about that, right? Think about like how much information about the candidate is absolutely lost in that handshake.

Graham - **01:16:39**

Yep. Well, there'd be one way to do it of just saying like, you want a multi dimensional resume, but I don't even know what that means. I mean,.

Eric Zelman - **01:16:53**

Well, I think that's what I'm, that's sort of what this is. That's this, you know, that's this idea of a file that isn't just your resume but has like all your stuff in it. Right. Like, how much does Graham want for compensation? What is Graham willing to do? What is Graham not willing to do? What are Graham's, you know, like what is. So let's go back to this text file because it's just ugly, but it, it sort of serves its purpose. Like, so I have my resume uploaded as a text file. Okay, that's great. But where's the thing I wanted to show you? This is. So here's a test profile. So what's different is that this doesn't show. You could show you my jobs, you know, and all of that.

Eric Zelman - **01:17:56**

But what this does, moreover, it talks about my communication style, it talks about my decision making. It has good and bad things about my decision making. Right. But I kind of want that in there because it flushes it out as being human. Right. I don't want to, I, I'm 55 and I need a job, but I also don't want to just make everything into the alpha ATS version of myself that has no flaws, you know, And it talks about what makes, what fulfills me and what drains me. And it talks about what kind of roles I want, like a builder role, how many times I've done this before. Industries. I want this can go on and on, but I tried to structure it in a way that, you know, to begin with that would just sort of be adaptable to a variety of people.

Graham - **01:18:52**

Yep. So my other thought is just, I mean, I just talked to a guy that worked for me who sort of had like a, in a sense a blue chip background of having worked like Morgan Stanley and BCG and things like that. I don't think he was a brilliant guy. I like him. He's honest. I think he tries hard. I think he didn't always conceptually get it, but he's now created a company. They're doing like 4,4 million a year in revenue. It's been doing it for seven years and it's basically an SI company and they've developed, they do like fintech projects and things like that for certain companies. He's not technical, so it's not like he was doing it. It's like he figured out how to put together a.

Graham - **01:19:52**

Actually, after he left igt when I left, when everyone was let go and he started trying to sell like soup and stuff like that, like just be an entrepreneur and open these soup restaurants and did that for a while and there were some challenges with that. So he stopped and he's now the CEO of this company and doing well. And it just, I mean, what's interesting is I wouldn't, it's not like I looked at him and said everything signals to me that this guy is going to be a successful entrepreneur. I almost looked at it and said like, this is a guy who's going to be a corporate cog. Yeah, but I would just say, in a sense, do make a minimum viable product and just try to sell it.

Eric Zelman - **01:20:45**

Yeah, I mean, that's sort of what I'm trying to do. And that's why I'm asking just for. So let me just get back to the core ask because I mean, it's fascinating and awesome to talk about it and I'm excited to. I'm, I'm. I mean, I'm so thankful that you're giving me time to talk about this because it's like so helpful to me. But let me show you. So, so the real thing here. Did I already blow this away? Was where are we? Here we go. Is that you're just going to test the, the first iteration of the chatbot. Right. So it's going to just walk you through uploading materials, like your resume, writing samples, maybe screenshots of things from LinkedIn, because as I said, I don't have a good scraper disk assessments, really.

Eric Zelman - **01:21:40**

I think if you have four or five, six, three or four things that can help flesh out Graham Jaraback in his career, I think that's really super useful. If it's only your resume, then it's only your resume, you know, and again, it could be like, I, I think I, I don't know if I mentioned this to you know, it could grow to be other things for other people. Alyssa wanted to try it. I was like, you know, you could upload screenshots of design projects you did, because AI can read all that and understand your graphic design identity and style. I mean there's a lot that can happen and then it's going to

ask you, are you employed? Actively searching and transition. This changes some of the inflection of the chatbot.

Eric Zelman - **01:22:27**

And I think the reason that this is, for me, it's instructional to have it there because one of the things that I think of this product doing in the future is that this could be something that someone uses or has or say that I have a service where we do. We find opportunities for people. They could just have this thing running in the background. They could be pretty happy with their job. Maybe they're not 100 happy, but they want something that goes out and almost does reverse recruiting for them while they're doing their, their okay job. It's not their dream job, but they'd love to know if there was something better out there based on like, who they think they really are. Right. Their aspirational self. And then it's gonna just, it's gonna walk you through series of steps.

Eric Zelman - **01:23:18**

It's gonna take 20 to 40 minutes to do that. And it's gonna start off with the chatbot and it's gonna already ingested your content, so it's gonna know more about you here. It's gonna have the context of all the stuff you uploaded. It's gonna parsed all that before it gets into the chat and starts to go through a discovery process of what you've uploaded, your disc assessments, your resume and all that. And it's going to have a conversation with you about your values and all those things that go into that.

Graham - **01:23:46**

Okay, and what, like in terms of privacy and stuff, how does that work with this?

Eric Zelman - **01:23:53**

Right now it's all going to me, so in the future it won't. And I think all those things, I have to be completely transparent right now. This is all just vibe Coded, So it's all going to me. And there's other interesting things here. If you start sorting through Google or in your browser and you go to the developer console, you can see my Anthropic API key and you can start running code using my Anthropic license. It's definitely a very alpha kind of thing. So I don't want to, I mean, has it's. It's SSL encrypted on the way there. It's not like it's just going over plain text, but the data itself is not stored in a place that I would say guarantees security. It's basically going to a developer prototype site called Vercel, which is pretty common.

Eric Zelman - **01:25:02**

That information is then getting parsed and sent to me via email and going into airtable. Okay. So I can tell you

where it goes. Could it better? Absolutely.

Graham - **01:25:18**

Okay.

Eric Zelman - **01:25:19**

It's also, I mean, you know, like, the other thing about my testing right now is, I mean, luckily I have friends like you who are willing to talk to me for an hour and there's the Friday morning or went Thursday morning. But, you know, I'm also kind of a little bit like, I want to get something out there. I also don't want to be stupid about it. So, like, there are a couple of people where I. Probably not friends, not our friends, but like where I, you know, came up with an NDA because I was like, well, you know, I don't want to sound arrogant, but maybe I should NDA some people, you know.

Graham - **01:25:50**

Yep.

Eric Zelman - **01:25:53**

So, yeah, I'm trying to get through the first 20 testers and if people are like, oh, this is shite, fuck it's broken, just let me know. I don't want to kill. I don't want to break any relationships over it. I'm just really hopeful to get some feedback Brandon gave me. Brandon started right away. He was like, oh, well, you know, I don't like your form. It's like, tell me all about it. There's also, in the instructions I'm going to send you, there's a feedback form, I think, I don't know if I sent it to you already, but there's a feedback form where you can voice concerns too. There's a feedback form that I'm going to ask you to fill out at the end of this.

Eric Zelman - **01:26:42**

I think that the minimum viable product is this tool that will create an MD or a text file and then at some point create a prettier, nicer PDF file and that something like that might just be A free tool that's going to be the minimum viable product and then the future product is going to be something again. Like I showed in that sort of prototype investor slide where it would be maybe a premium version that would be tied to series of scrapers or shovels that would help you find things for real and score them for you. Like, I think I showed you this, the beginning. It might give you like a weekly report, you know, the things that matched for you, how you fit opportunities, what fits, what doesn't. Could be something like this.

Graham - **01:27:38**

Yeah,.

Eric Zelman - **01:27:48**

Yeah. It's a, it's a long explanation. And I, and I worry that the explanation is so long that by the time people use it, they're like, this is really boring. Why is he spending so much time on this? So.

Graham - **01:28:00**

Well, I think that's why, in a sense, like, as I said before, like, I kind of get it. I kind of, I kind of don't. But that's where, like having sort of an elevator pitch. It's like, you know, this is a, whatever boutique thing that, you know, reshapes some professional criteria, but filters in a little bit more of personality assessment and personal needs or something than the other systems. It's more similar to these things, but it's still a little bit different. I mean, so to me, like, in the conversation, one of the interesting things is when you said Jack and Jill, because that to me was like, in a sense, I would say, how does Jack and Jill fit into the entire ecosystem? And then how is yours sort of similar or different to that?

Graham - **01:29:08**

Yeah, because there's part of me that's like, this is super exciting. And there's part of me, like, it's just going to be more work and more debt. Like, I'm just going to get more data. But, like, why is this format of data better than another format of data?

Eric Zelman - **01:29:25**

Yeah, yeah. So here's, here's Jack and Jill, right? Jack and Jill, just while we're here, you run away yet? Jack and Jill basically presents jobs to you, has a really great chatbot, can help you with searching for roles, can coach you for an interview, can help make suggestions in your cv. And it basically is doing a lot of the things that I pay Claude to do for me. So you're just getting an AI chatbot. And like, I was joking about, like, with. Or I didn't tell this to you. I was joking with Brendan about this. I was saying to him, like, tell me about Pythagoras, you know, like it's, it's a chatbot and it's not. I mean I don't know if this. I, I put some code in it the other day and it gave me this long.

Eric Zelman - **01:30:22**

I was using it as like a free coding engine because it's not what it's designed for, but ultimately it's a chatbot and it's pretty easy to manipulate. But here's the thing, what it's good at is that it knows my profile pretty well. It knows my zero to one build mandate, it knows that I prefer remote, that I have various things in my profile. Here's what the profile of builds looks like. I uploaded my summary, my resume, so it has all that stuff. It's going to have. Where else it's going to have some flags, some basic things around. Again, similar but more basic versions of what I built. So prettier. Like it's going to have like signals. Right. Like location, good fit, bad fit, not a fit compensation, company culture, role, but it's not flexible.

Eric Zelman - **01:31:29**

It doesn't let you say export this or use this as a tool elsewhere. And so I think that they, you know, again, I'm not kidding. I'm trying not to kid myself. I'm trying to be pragmatic about it. I think that this company has a lot of the things that my tool or my thinking that they have a lot of the technologies or ways that they could do what I'm trying to do, but they don't seem to be interested in doing it. Like they kind of scratch the surface a little bit, but they don't go all the way.

Graham - **01:32:08**

Yep.

Eric Zelman - **01:32:09**

And so from a product point of view, I'm trying to understand is that an opportunity or am I just going down the wrong direction? You know, like they've got the whole track jobs thing, which I think is great, but I'm not trying to do that because there are lots of sites that you can track your jobs. And I think that again, as I said, I think that the profile, the personal profile is so valuable. And actually what I found is that by having my own personal profile I can feed that profile into this and get this to give me better results. So I'm kind of using my lens tool to tell this how to find me better results.

Graham - **01:32:53**

Yeah, Yep. I mean one of the other things I'll just mention, which is. So when I was in New Mexico, I was trying to network and I found this group, the New Mexico Angels. And they were like nice people and it gave Me a lot of like people to talk to and we'd sort of talk about. I mean theoretically it was to find angel investors. And there were a couple of things. Like. One was I, I worked with or I spoke to a guy and he had a. He was, he had a startup, he did batteries and he's now a venture capitalist. So I would guess that he did okay with the exit, but it was a non lithium based battery.

Eric Zelman - **01:33:44**

That's an awesome thing. I love hearing that though because like lithium is the death of us.

Graham - **01:33:51**

Yeah, so he was doing that and with. Yeah, so he was doing that. And one of the things I realized, and I think it's probably true of you, is we're much more operational. So he was more like big concept and like trying to put together a team and you could tell like his team had holes and stuff like that. And there were challenges and. But he wasn't like. I mean, one is they were trying to get something validated. And so like my thing was like, what's the process like? He was like, they said they might not even have time to like look at it or whatever. And it's like, well, it's a step to do it. So I was thinking about it more operationally, but I think he may have succeeded with it. I haven't talked to him without that night.

Graham - **01:34:47**

Like when I talked to this friend recently, he's thinking about IPOing on NASDAQ. It's like a very small company. And then he's like, yeah, we're going to try to use M and A to grow. And it's like to me it sounds like again, he's not that operational in the sense of. Or his focus is all about trying to get the IPO to work.

Eric Zelman - **01:35:11**

I think that there's a lot of people who are like the, I mean, the prototype, you know, the. So there's. We live in a world for good or for bad, where Basically every single CEO under the age of 60 walks around imagining that they at some point were Steve Jobs and that they are the vision person because that's how they pimp to get money. Because that's how companies unfortunately in our world now are built. They're not built on, they're not all. And not always, but often, especially in software, they're built on this pitch deck and you know, getting VC firms to get excited and I don't. And I get really lost in the trees. I get lost in the forest. Right. So my, as you said, where's your elevator? Pitch, and I'm so happy to go off script. So what I'm doing with.

Eric Zelman - **01:36:13**

In regards to that and trying to tamper myself or keep guardrails up for myself is using a lot of AI basically to write. Write materials that are more succinct and more direct. And I think at some point, though, I mean, as good as that is or as bad as that is, I think that for me to be successful in a business like this, that I would need to find someone who was more of the pitch money person to help me build something out, because I don't see myself as being that.

Graham - **01:36:50**

Yep.

Eric Zelman - **01:36:51**

You know.

Graham - **01:36:52**

Yeah. Anyway, I think, I mean, I think part of it was just. I just mentioned that because it's an interesting story for me, but I think that there's a little bit of. Yeah, you can build up a team around it if you need to. Another is there are lots of ways to success. And so, I mean, maybe the only thing a little bit different that I would do with the way you're speaking is like, at this point you're saying, I don't know if it makes sense, but you may just want to say, like, be a little bit more assertive with it. Saying, like, I have this idea. It really works for me. I think it may be useful for other people and, you know, trying to get it out there or whatever.

Eric Zelman - **01:37:36**

Yeah, no, I agree. I, I don't want to. I don't want to stand down on it. I think I. No, you're. You're totally right. And, but, you know, also, I've known you since I was 15 years old, so it's like, there's only so much of the spin that I can put on anything because you know me so well. So it's like I'm. When I talk to you and, and my friends, it's different. When I talk to people who I used to work with, it's a little bit different there. I mean, I'm less guarded with them now that we all don't work together, so they're also friends. When I go to talk to this retired Goldman Sachs HR person, I'm just, I just want to listen. I'm not. I don't want to go in with her.

Eric Zelman - **01:38:16**

I want to sound certainly reasonably assertive, but also humble too, because she spent 30 years, I mean, recruiting for Goldman Sachs is like, if you did that during the 80s and whatever. I mean, she's like, brendan was funny. He's like, so you're gonna talk to her On Tuesday. I'm like, yeah, we're gonna talk for half an hour. Brendan's like, you should fly there to see her. That's how big of a person that is. I'm like, no, she's just, she, it's cool. I don't think she wants to see me in person. But yeah, no, I, I, There is a, there is definitely the pitch Eric. And then there's the Eric that is like, I'm planning on trying, I'm trying to find all the holes in my argument.

Eric Zelman - **01:39:01**

One of the things I hate most about AI, frankly is that on the one hand I can put this in and be like, do a patent search. And it's like, this is an interesting thing. Or these facts aren't, you know, this isn't there. The thing I hate, even with Claude code sometimes, is that AI systems, even the code engine are a little sycophantic, you know, like,

even if you tell it to dial it down, it's always still there because it thinks that it's so self confident. Like, it's like, here's the latest build of your scraper. It's going to work. It's going to solve all your problems. And I'm like, no, it's totally busted. It doesn't work. And you're just, you know, why are you so confident?

Graham - **01:39:41**

Yeah, no, I, I mean, like, I'm still doing data science stuff. In fact, I would just say, like right now, I mean, I think the only way to really describe what I'm doing is I'm basically retired because I'm not looking for work. I don't even know what to do. And there's a little bit where I feel like the world is. It's all about the square box and I didn't fit into it. And then there's a little bit of just the basic initiative which you're showing to, you know, you're showing by sort of developing this of like when you just talk about disk, it's like, I probably could get certified to do something like disc, but to me there's still a way in which I want to work with smart, interesting people and I want to contribute like insights and knowledge.

Graham - **01:40:39**

But I don't want to be like the lead person. I, I think that my personality is being more of the internal, like the consigliere type thing, like, of just thinking a lot about stuff, but I'm not the trigger person. Yeah, and, but so, I mean,.

Eric Zelman - **01:41:00**

So you're Like a coo.

Graham - **01:41:04**

Well, I have no idea where I fit in the world. Like, I don't. I've just, I mean, with the, with that last job, like, I stopped. I haven't looked for a job in two years and just getting older and I just think, like, the likelihood that I find another job is kind of small, but I guess there's a little bit of just like social media or like these dis things. There are trillions of people. I mean, I'd probably say I haven't been that impressed with that many people I've worked with. And I think I'm smart enough. I think I have enough initiative. Like, yeah, plus, or, you know, maybe a little bit more pessimistic than some, A lot more optimistic than a lot. But I just haven't found, I haven't found a space for it.

Graham - **01:41:51**

And I have friends that are becoming like, coaches or whatever. And.

Eric Zelman - **01:41:57**

I mean, I think coaching would be a great thing. I mean, there's a lot of ways of bringing that back to people. I met some people who are cool coaches. The two that I picked, I really like a lot of. And I'm hopeful that they'll stay as, I mean, they've offered to serve, advise, and to participate.

Graham - **01:42:13**

Yeah, that's cool because I, I would say that the people I found, like,.

Eric Zelman - **01:42:23**

I mean, if you ever need 500,.

Graham - **01:42:26**

$5,000 For these things, it's like, I don't think it was that useful. In fact, I would say it was sort of unuseful.

Eric Zelman - **01:42:39**

Yeah. Yeah. I mean, I, I, I'm, look, I, I don't, you know, Alyssa's like, what was the point? It didn't get you a job. And I was like, well, I, you know, this gets into a contentious topic, but it's like, I don't think in either case, I was looking for the coach to find me a job. And I know that, like, that's not what coaches do. I mean, there are people I've had people approach me on various, you know, LinkedIn or whatever who are, like, fishing for people that they can sell their, their coaching methodology to where they're like, I'll get you a job in whatever, four months or, and then if I don't, then, you know, I get refund 50% of your money or whatever. Those kinds of Ponzi schemes. I don't think that is real.

Eric Zelman - **01:43:26**

And so I look at it like, I just want a coach that's going to help me align where I was because I spent 13 years, heads down, I didn't really think about, for 30 years, frankly, of just running from job to job. I didn't plan my career out. I didn't get an advanced degree. So it was like, oh, this job is available. I'll take that. This job worked. It didn't. I'll have to find the next one. Okay, now I'm doing something adjacent because that's what was available. Right. So for me to make sense of what the am I good at is hard to assess.

Eric Zelman - **01:44:02**

It's harder than maybe, you know, if I had been a teacher for 20 years or I had, you know, I went and got an advanced degree and then did that and was on a trajectory with that, you know what I mean? So I think for me, I. Coaching was as much about sort of stepping back and just like taking a look or at what I've done. And I needed a long time to do that. And it. And unfortunately it's expensive. Right. You know, but it's helped a lot. And I think that that could be valuable for people. And I think that having a tool that could help coaching, facilitate coaching and I think a tool that can help people have that perspective would be really valuable so that. I definitely believe it.

Graham - **01:44:51**

Yeah. And I mean, I think like, I don't know about disc, but I know some of the things like whatever that, like you go on and like you can take our test and it will give you the free results, but if you want to like get a consultant to actually go through it with you pay more or whatever.

Eric Zelman - **01:45:08**

Yeah, yeah. And I think that, I think, you know, one of the things I was saying todd, one of my coaches, was this idea of a tool like this as being most valuable when what I have to say, I said coach guided AI, you know.

Graham - **01:45:25**

Yeah, well, the other, I mean the other thing that I'll just say about that Angels group, which I thought was interesting and I. Well, at one point I would have said there are a lot of people coming in with business models that are AI and so one was psychology and. Like psychology. And so this person used to be a psychologist and knew like a lot of good practices and was trying to develop an engine and this would like, you know, enable more people to access decent psychology, but through AI or whatever. And, and their own proprietary engine. One was a company that did immigration law and just saying like it would facilitate lower cost understanding of whether you could immigrate. This was pre Trump, I think.

Graham - **01:46:29**

And like what sort of the challenges Were, but things that were designed to sort of move you along the track. And so I think another one was this is an AI generated tool to find out more about like your background, like related to like getting Medicare because her grandfather used to get a million calls and they would have these really long surveys and they just were like unempathetic and not relevant and stuff like that. And I don't know how she did, she was a journalist and sort of said like I have these journalistic things of questions you can ask to elicit more of the relevant information and more of a format that people are willing to engage in. Yeah, and I know at one point I heard her saying like she was looking for money and she's just like, I'm just so tired.

Graham - **01:47:30**

Like I just kind of want to either get money or to be out.

Eric Zelman - **01:47:35**

I mean, so I talk with the founder of Big can pretty frequently. He went back to Australia. So David, so I mean Big can got to about, I don't know, 130, 140 million in ARR at its peak and you know, about 350 employees. And along the way David spent a lot of time hustling to get money and funding and 10 here, 20 there and I don't know, we got up to about probably 100 million in funding at some point. But the thing is that at this point he went and he left and he started a company in Australia that's basically doing AI infrastructure. And his pitch was to build AI infrastructure that was sovereign to Australia because, you know, people don't want to offshore their data and so on and so forth. Here's the tale of the tape.

Eric Zelman - **01:48:44**

David said to me, he said SaaS software as a business model is dead. And that all of these AI companies, none of them have any moat. You know, there's no defensible position because they're all built on, you know, chatbots and the software can almost write itself and on and on. So from his perspective, the only way that he's going to make money and what he's pitching to get his, to get to his, you know, 100 or 200 million in funding that he's, he's trying to, he's trying to pull in is tokenization. Tokenization is the only, is that layer outside of hardware is the only viable business model. He thinks it's the only safe one because he thinks everything else, he's being very sarcastic but also pretty honest that everything else is going to get anything else could be Easily washed away.

Eric Zelman - **01:49:41**

And I don't discount it.

Graham - **01:49:43**

What is, what is tokenization?

Eric Zelman - **01:49:46**

So every time you use, every time you make a call to OpenAI or anthropic or whoever, right. The system uses

tokens to value the amount of compute time or the difficulty of answering that question or performing that task. So tokenization is basically the commodity layer of AI infrastructure. And so it's not done in teraflops, it's not done in megabytes, it's not done in throughput of megabits per second or anything like that. It's all done in this model of tokenization. And models, AI models are all built around tokenization efficiency. So that's the low layer, lower layer of machine learning and AI is, you know, how do you make this token model more efficient so that your product can do more with less? Okay, so he thinks that tokenization and token and brokering, tokenization or brokering tokens is really the thing.

Eric Zelman - **01:51:08**

Almost like what's happening now is that you have companies like Nvidia that certainly are making all the hardware the law of AI runs off of, but you have marketplaces for literally buying tokens at bulk cost, at lower cost. So you know, you want to be able to do your AI projects at scale. Your company might decide to buy from a token broker. Fundamentally, I think that the thing that I'm doing doesn't get around any of that. But it's also why I'm not that it's also why I'm a bit guarded or understand that I don't want to go into this as being, you know, build this big workflow, this end to end workflow and it's gonna be this website, it's gonna do all this for you.

Eric Zelman - **01:52:04**

Because although sites like Jack and Jill got some money, I, you know, he's like, everyone's basically holding their money. No one wants to spend anything because everyone feels like, not just because of global uncertainty, but just because of this where AI is right now, it's not so much that it's going to crash, it's more like that no business model in of itself is defensible because someone else can come up with something that's like something else that's cheaper, does this kind of thing. So for me, I feel like what I have to lean in on here is the, is this sort of value proposition of the uniqueness of the scoring and around that than the actual chat bot or the site or any of the other things that makes sense.

Graham - **01:52:49**

Yeah, I mean, what's Interesting is like, I read the media when I use, like, I'm still doing data science stuff and I've gotten bet, like I, I took a bunch of classes and those classes had projects. And it's like, what I realize is I remember some basic concepts, a lot of the coding details. Some I remember, some I forget. I've definitely gotten sort of better. Well, I've both gotten better at it and some I get worse at if like I took a specific class and really knew how to do it. But I just look at AI and it's so powerful at the same time, like it's sycophantic. And in addition to being sycophantic, like, I'll say, what about this? And they're like, that's a great idea. Why don't you go in that direction? And then later I'll think about something else.

Graham - **01:53:43**

And I'm like, well, what about this? And they're like, yeah, just add more variables. And so it's like, I don't fully know. Like, maybe at one stage we'll say, oh, reduce the number of variables. This is how you do it. And then at another stage when I'm like, well, the clusters aren't that well distinguished. Should I use more variables? And they're like, oh, that's a, you know, that's an awesome, like, really deep idea and you should try adding more variables. And this is some of the variables you can add. And I sort of think about it like, well, am I ever going to get to a point where I can use this? And I sort of say yes or no. And it's like, well, I enjoy the engagement so I'm going to continue with it.

But there's a level in which.

Graham - **01:54:24**

Well, when I saw Neil Sover, I saw him in January, went out to Colorado.

Eric Zelman - **01:54:29**

Yeah, yeah, I saw a picture.

Graham - **01:54:32**

Yeah. And he said he feels like AI is sort of like an overzealous junior developer.

Eric Zelman - **01:54:41**

Oh, it totally is. It totally is. That's what I was saying before is it'll tell you it's so confident that it's written the best thing in the world and it's a piece of junk.

Graham - **01:54:50**

Well, well, that's where like, yeah, I mean, at one one sense, it's amazing and you can ask it anything and it customizes answer on another side. Like, it doesn't always work or you come and ask a different question and it will give a different answer. But sometimes I feel like it almost goes into a track where it always provides the Same answer. Even though I'm not sure that it's always thinking about it. But one hand I see like it's more impressive than it was several years ago. It's amazing like what it can do. It's amazing when you think about like when were kids there were like computers were just coming out in a sense or at least personal computers and like how much better and how much those have changed.

Graham - **01:55:40**

I mean it's amazing to think that when were young there was no browser, no cell phone, no all these things. And now they're like totally common. And in looking at AI like I do think AI is just going to become increasingly powerful and do more things. And then at the same time like I look around and it's like I don't know anyone who like in Taiwan and maybe it's because people are older. Like I think more and more people are using AI. But it hasn't gotten to the point where it's like I really know anyone who's gotten laid off because of AI.

Eric Zelman - **01:56:19**

Well, I mean in my, you know, background, because I was running support, I can see I've seen thousands, I mean not from people who work for me because I didn't manage thousands of people, but I mean I've seen a lot of people in those customer facing roles be affected by AI. Like I said, there are people in those entry level jobs, they all got wiped out by AI. And it was always just a question of you're either going to outsource them, like if you had someone who used to help you answer questions about how do I reset my password, that job doesn't exist anymore. You know, that's all the, that's what AI chatbots are great at now. Is it better, you know, can it do everything? Absolutely not. Right. But there's so many places where those entry level jobs are gone because of it.

Eric Zelman - **01:57:10**

And I managed a team of people who, you know, some were senior and then there were a bunch of people in their 20s. And at times, you know, I've let people go not because I replaced them with AI, but just because the market pressure was there and we had to find a cheaper way of doing it. And when I was there, you know, a year ago, almost a year ago, I can't believe it's almost, you know, July will be a year. I didn't feel like the tools were really mature enough for me to start laying people off. Just because we're going to do AI. And also, I mean just be real about it wasn't that it was cheaper.

Eric Zelman - **01:57:44**

I mean, I was like, okay, I can have a team of people do entry level work who live in Ukraine or Romania or, you know, that could go down market farther like India or the Philippines. And that is going to be arguably cheaper than paying for the AI licenses. So it was like, why? You know.

Graham - **01:58:08**

Yep.

Eric Zelman - **01:58:09**

But that'll change. That'll change. It's just getting cheaper and cheaper.

Graham - **01:58:16**

Yep. I mean, it's interesting too. You talk about like the offshoring because it's like the last company I worked for, it's like it was an American based company. Most of the customers were in the US and at the same time they only had like four employees in the US and they had come people in like South Africa. South Africa and the Philippines. But anyway, good chatting with you, man. I'm sorry you're out of work. Sorry. I'm out of work to some degree and very happy in other ways. I mean, I sort of have gotten to a point where I'm just like, did I ever really like any of the stuff I did? Seriously?

Graham - **01:59:02**

Like, I still have a resume, I guess, but it's like, did I really enjoy it or was it just like I made one decision and then another decision and it sort of led to a path. But I keep thinking to it of like, in a sense I'm conservative, but in a sense, like, I moved out of the country. Like, I decided I didn't want to work in gaming anymore and haven't worked in gaming anymore. I've made some big, bold decisions, but they haven't really panned out very well.

Eric Zelman - **01:59:34**

I mean, like, so I. I gotta go to bed soon and I totally want to hang out and catch up, but I. We went to Alyssa's aunt invited us to visit them list. His aunt has house in the Vineyard, which is amazing. And were there last weekend for the Martha's Vineyard Film Festival. Which is funny because the Martha's Vineyard Film Festival is basically just a bunch of really, really wealthy people from Massachusetts who just live in Martha's Vi.